



Toronto CollegeTM
of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries^{Inc.}

Multi-Year Plan

2026-2031

Introduction

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to ensuring equal access and participation for people with disabilities. TCDHA is dedicated to treating all individuals with dignity and independence, and to meeting accessibility needs in a timely manner by identifying, removing, and preventing barriers across its operations.

This Multi-Year Accessibility Plan outlines the policies, practices, and actions that TCDHA will implement to comply with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA) and the Integrated Accessibility Standards Regulation (IASR). This plan reflects TCDHA's ongoing commitment to the principles of dignity, independence, integration, and equal opportunity, as well as its obligations under the Ontario Human Rights Code.

TCDHA recognizes that its responsibilities under the AODA do not replace or limit its obligations under the Ontario Human Rights Code. TCDHA will continue to meet its current and ongoing obligations to provide accommodations for individuals with disabilities, up to the point of undue hardship, taking into account health, safety, and operational requirements.

This plan applies to all goods, services, facilities, and operations of TCDHA and includes initiatives in the following areas in accordance with IASR standards:

- Customer Service
- Information and Communications
- Employment
- Training
- Built Environment

TCDHA will maintain documented policies and ensure they are publicly available. Accessible formats of this Multi-Year Accessibility Plan and related documents will be provided upon request, in a timely manner and at no additional cost, in consultation with the individual making the request.

TCDHA will:

- Review and update this Multi-Year Accessibility Plan at least once every five (5) years, or more frequently as required
- Monitor progress on an ongoing basis and adjust priorities to improve accessibility outcomes
- Provide accessible formats and communication supports upon request

TCDHA is committed to ensuring that all employees, volunteers, and individuals involved in developing policies or providing services receive appropriate accessibility training. Training will be provided as soon as practicable after hire and on an ongoing basis when changes occur. Records of training will be maintained in accordance with legislative requirements.

Through this plan, TCDHA reaffirms its commitment to continuous improvement in accessibility and to contributing to a fully accessible and inclusive Ontario.

Customer Service

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to providing accessible customer service to all individuals, including persons with disabilities. TCDHA strives for excellence in serving all clients and will provide goods, services, and facilities in a manner that respects the dignity, independence, integration, and equal opportunity of people with disabilities.

TCDHA will ensure that its policies, practices, and procedures governing the provision of goods, services, and facilities comply with the Accessibility Standards for Customer Service under the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA).

In delivering accessible customer service, TCDHA supports the use of assistive devices and welcomes the presence of service animals and support persons in areas open to the public, in accordance with applicable legislation. Staff will be trained on how to interact appropriately with individuals using these supports.

Communication and Support

TCDHA will communicate with individuals with disabilities in ways that take into account their disability. The organization will work with each individual to determine the most appropriate method of communication and will provide accessible formats and communication supports upon request, in a timely manner and at no additional cost.

Communication supports may include, but are not limited to:

- In-person, written, or electronic communication
- Assistive technologies or devices
- Alternative document formats

TCDHA will consult with the person making the request to ensure the suitability of the communication support or accessible format provided.

Feedback Process

TCDHA welcomes feedback on the accessibility of its customer service. Feedback may be provided through various accessible methods, including in person, by email, or through written submissions. Accessible formats and communication supports will be made available upon request. All feedback will be reviewed and addressed in accordance with TCDHA's feedback procedures.

Notice of Temporary Disruption

In the event of a planned or unexpected disruption to services or facilities that may impact individuals with disabilities, TCDHA will provide prompt notice. This notice will include information about the reason for the disruption, its anticipated duration, and any available alternative services or facilities. Notices will be posted in visible locations and provided in accessible formats upon request.

Information and Communications

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to providing accessible information and communication supports for all individuals, including persons with disabilities.

TCDHA will communicate with people in ways that take into account their disability and will provide accessible formats and communication supports upon request, in a timely manner and at no additional cost. The organization will consult with the individual making the request to determine the most appropriate accessible format or communication support.

Accessible formats and communication supports may include, but are not limited to:

- Alternative document formats (e.g., digital or print formats)
- Assistive technologies or software
- Reading information aloud or providing written materials
- Use of interpreters or other communication supports

Students and Academic Accommodations

TCDHA is committed to supporting students with disabilities by providing academic accommodations in accordance with the Ontario Human Rights Code, up to the point of undue hardship, taking into account health, safety, and academic requirements.

Accommodation requests will be assessed on an individual basis. Students are encouraged to communicate their needs to the appropriate program contact to determine suitable accommodations.

As a post-secondary institution offering clinically based programs, certain essential requirements must be met to ensure safe and competent practice. These may include communication, cognitive, and physical skills necessary to perform clinical procedures. TCDHA will work with students to explore



appropriate accommodations while maintaining the integrity of program requirements.

Unconvertible Information

If TCDHA determines that information or communications cannot be converted into an accessible format, the organization will provide the individual with:

- An explanation as to why the information or communication is unconvertible; and
- A summary of the unconvertible information

Notice of Disruption

In the event of a planned or unexpected disruption to services or facilities that may impact access for individuals with disabilities, TCDHA will provide prompt notice. Notices will include the reason for the disruption, its anticipated duration, and a description of alternative services or facilities, if available. Notices will be posted in visible locations and made available in accessible formats upon request.

Digital Accessibility

TCDHA is committed to meeting the requirements of the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0 Level AA and will work toward alignment with WCAG 2.1 standards as a best practice to ensure accessible digital content.

Training

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to providing training on accessibility to all employees, volunteers, and other individuals who interact with the public or who are involved in the development of organizational policies.

Training will be provided in accordance with the requirements of the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA) and will include applicable accessibility standards as well as the Ontario Human Rights Code as it relates to persons with disabilities.

Training will include:

- An overview of the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 and its standards
- The Ontario Human Rights Code as it relates to persons with disabilities
- How to interact and communicate with people with various types of disabilities
- How to interact with individuals who use assistive devices or require the assistance of a service animal or support person
- How to use equipment or devices available on-site that may assist in providing services to individuals with disabilities, where applicable
- What to do if a person with a disability is having difficulty accessing TCDHA's goods, services, or facilities

Training will be provided as soon as practicable after hire and on an ongoing basis when changes are made to accessibility policies, practices, or procedures. Training will be tailored to the duties of the individual.

TCDHA will maintain records of the training provided, including the dates on which training was delivered and the number of individuals who completed the training.

Workplace Emergency Response Information

TCDHA will provide individualized workplace emergency response information to employees who have a disability, where necessary. This information will be developed in consultation with the employee and will take into account their specific needs. Emergency response information will be reviewed when:

- The employee moves to a different location
- The employee's accommodation needs change
- TCDHA reviews its general emergency response policies



Student Training and Preparedness

TCDHA integrates accessibility awareness and inclusive service practices into student learning. Through clinical training and community placements, students gain experience working with individuals with diverse needs, including persons with disabilities, seniors, and children. This supports the development of skills required to provide accessible, respectful, and timely care to all clients.

Employment

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to fair and accessible employment practices. TCDHA will notify employees and job applicants that accommodations are available during recruitment, assessment, and hiring processes and will consult with individuals to provide suitable accommodations upon request. The organization will also support employees with disabilities throughout their employment by providing accessible workplace information, individualized accommodation plans, and workplace emergency response information, in accordance with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA) and the Ontario Human Rights Code.

Other

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to providing accessible facilities and ensuring that the built environment supports the needs of individuals with disabilities.

TCDHA's premises include accessible features such as ramp access to entrances, designated accessible parking, elevator access to the second floor, and wheelchair-accessible clinical and service areas. Clients may be accommodated on either floor and in any of the three clinics based on accessibility needs and preferences.

TCDHA will continue to identify, remove, and prevent barriers within its physical environment, and will take accessibility into account when making



modifications to existing spaces or planning future improvements, in accordance with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA).

The Next 5-Years

Over the next five years, Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) will continue to enhance accessibility across all areas of its operations and services. TCDHA is committed to ongoing compliance with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA) and to continuous improvement in accessibility practices.

TCDHA will:

- Review and update accessibility policies and procedures on a regular basis to ensure ongoing compliance and effectiveness
- Provide accessible formats and communication supports upon request in a timely manner and at no additional cost
- Continue to integrate accessibility considerations into recruitment, hiring, and employment practices
- Ensure that all employees complete required accessibility training and receive updated training when policies or practices change
- Strengthen staff awareness and capacity to respond to diverse accessibility needs in service delivery
- Identify and address barriers within programs, services, and facilities, and implement improvements where feasible
- Incorporate accessibility considerations into organizational planning, processes, and decision-making

TCDHA will monitor progress on these initiatives and adjust priorities as needed to improve accessibility outcomes.

For more information on TCDHA's Accessibility Policy or Multi-Year Accessibility Plan, or to provide feedback on accessibility, individuals may contact the college through the contact information available on its website <https://www.toronto-college-dental.org/contact.html>.



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Accessible formats of this document are available upon request at no additional cost.